LANDLORDLEDGER · RATE WATCH · FREE CHECKLIST

ADJUSTABLE-RATE MORTGAGE CHECKLIST

MBA weekly survey (week ending Oct 23), released Oct 28, 2026: ARMs = 11.3% of applications, a 1-year+ high.

THE NUMBERS (MBA, OCT 28, 2026)

- [ ] ARM share of applications: 11.3%, highest in more than a year
- [ ] 5/1 ARM avg 6.41% vs 30-yr fixed avg 7.37%
- [ ] $300K loan: about $190/month less at the start (principal & interest)

ASK THE LENDER IN WRITING

- [ ] Fixed period _____ years · Index _____ · Margin _____
- [ ] Caps: first adjustment _____ each adjustment _____ lifetime _____
- [ ] Worst-case payment after the first reset _____

STRESS TEST

- [ ] Could I afford the worst-case payment? Y / N
- [ ] How long will I keep this home? _____ years
- [ ] Prepayment penalty? Y / N

REMEMBER

- [ ] An ARM is cheaper only until it resets; rates can rise or fall
- [ ] Compare 3 same-day Loan Estimates (fixed and ARM)
- [ ] **BONUS: how ARM caps work, step by step: Rate Watch · Part 2 on the page**

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